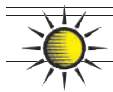


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Sunny, hazy 83/62 • Tomorrow: Sunny, hazy 88/66 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, JUNE 3, 2025 • \$4

Strikes lift spirits in Ukraine, stun Russia

Drone attacks showcase Kyiv's innovations — and Moscow's vulnerabilities

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY, FRANCESCA EBEL, SERHIY MORGUNOV AND ALEX HORTON

KYIV — For 18 months, Ukraine's internal security service planned an audacious assault on far-flung Russian airfields — first sneaking drones into Russia, then planting them near key military runways.

On Sunday, just ahead of a new round of peace talks, it was go time: Near four unsuspecting Russian military bases, remotely activated roofs lifted off mobile homes and sheds parked on flatbed trucks. Armed Ukrainian drones tucked inside soared upward, then pounced on military aircraft lined up on the runways, engulfing many in flames.

The brazen attack — which Ukrainian officials claimed destroyed at least 13 Russian aircraft and damaged dozens of others — shocked Russia and instantly reduced its capabilities to threaten a nuclear attack or launch missile strikes on Ukraine and other countries. It also served as a crucial reminder to Moscow and Ukraine's Western partners that Kyiv remains capable of exploiting Russia's weaknesses and disrupting its war plans, despite being outnumbered and outgunned.

Ukraine said the damaged or destroyed aircraft, some of which

SEE UKRAINE ON A10

Peace talks: Sides agree on a new prisoner exchange but little else. **A9**

GOP tries a quieter approach to ACA cuts

'Repeal and replace' gives way to efforts to push people off program

BY PAIGE WINFIELD CUNNINGHAM

Congressional Republicans are pursuing changes to the Affordable Care Act that would mean 10.7 million fewer Americans using its insurance marketplaces and Medicaid, a huge reduction that some view as a way to accomplish part of the health-care coverage cancellation that failed in 2017.

They're not branding it a repeal of President Barack Obama's signature health care law this time around, and this year's effort wouldn't erase its marketplaces or Medicaid expansion. Congress tried that the last time President Donald Trump was in office but abandoned it amid an outcry from the health care industry, advocates and voters.

But the GOP plan making its way through Congress would sharply increase the number of people without health insurance, largely by narrowing the path for poor Americans to gain coverage

SEE HEALTH CARE ON A2

Medicaid: Senator's joke shows party's messaging challenge. **A14**

A dramatic display in Sicily



FABRIZIO VILLA/GETTY IMAGES

An eruption at Mount Etna sent smoke and ash high into the air Monday. Officials said there was no threat to people nearby, but the volcano was temporarily closed to tourists. Eruptions at Etna are common, and Monday's activity came after part of the southeast crater collapsed, Italy's National Institute of Geophysics and Volcanology said.

Polish election builds on populist tide in Europe

Nationalist's narrow win reflects rising strength of MAGA-style movements

BY LEO SANDS

A conservative nationalist backed by President Donald Trump was elected to Poland's presidency over the weekend, capping a string of tightly fought contests that analysts say underscore the growing strength of far-right and populist parties in Europe — fueled in part by the influence of the MAGA movement from across the pond.

Karol Nawrocki, a historian supported by Poland's conservative Law and Justice party, narrowly defeated Warsaw's liberal mayor in Sunday's election, 50.89 percent to 49.11 percent.

Last month, U.S. Homeland Security Secretary Kristi L. Noem had urged Poles to elect him — the latest in a spate of controversial interventions by Trump administration officials into European domestic politics.

Nawrocki's victory comes a year after many far-right parties surged in the European parliamentary elections. Since then, far-right parties have continued to fare largely well: coming first in Austria, staging historic advances in Portugal and Germany, and making waves but ultimately falling short of expectations in Romania and France.

Daniel Hegedüs, a regional director at the German Marshall Fund think tank, said the narrowness of the results showed how

SEE EUROPE ON A11

Gridlock: Election keeps Polish government at a standstill. **A11**

Some DOGE reforms the opposite of efficient

New requirements add red tape that delays even simple federal functions

BY HANNAH NATANSON

Somewhere in the world last month, a State Department employee began the routine process of hiring a vendor for an upcoming embassy event — but quickly ran into a problem.

The vendor was refusing to sign paperwork certifying that it did not promote diversity, equity and inclusion, or "DEI," a new requirement under President Donald Trump's executive order eradicating DEI from the government. The State employee — who spoke on the condition that neither he nor the location of his embassy be

named, for fear of retaliation — sighed.

Then he got busy: The work-around, he knew, would take time. First, he got his ambassador's signed approval to hire the vendor anyway. Next, he filled out an Office 365 form justifying the expense in 250 words before selecting which "pillar" of necessary spending it fell under, choosing from options including "Safer, Stronger, More Prosperous." After submitting that to higher-ups and getting their sign-off, he filled out yet another form — this one destined for political appointees back in Washington.

A week later, the vendor was secured. Under any previous administration, it would have taken one day, the employee said.

SEE DOGE ON A4

National Park Service: Staffing plunges as peak season nears. **A3**

RETROPOLIS

Where stepping stones became a cornerstone

History of gay rights isn't complete without D.C.'s steady contributions to the movement

BY PETULA DVORAK

While Stonewall and San Francisco are iconic in the LGBTQ rights movement, it is official Washington that birthed some of the pivotal moments in that national fight for civil rights.

Washington became a haven for queer Americans, but it also was where prejudice was enshrined into law. That tension created seismic social changes that continue to reverberate.

The anguish of gay Americans who were called "sexual psychopaths" in Congress

and fired from their jobs fueled the first public demonstrations for gay rights in the nation. The fight for dignity continued through the AIDS epidemic and the battle for marriage equality.

But the spirit of that struggle also created a vibrant society. D.C. also claims America's oldest queer nightclub, an influential lesbian collective and a gay Black club that drew celebrities gay and straight.

D.C. built monuments to the thinkers, warriors and leaders who shook and

SEE PRIDE ON A6



HARRY NALTCHAYAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Jack Nichols, Frank E. Kameny and Lilli Vincenz protest government discrimination against gay people with others outside the White House in 1965. Kameny was a scientist who became an activist.

IN THE NEWS

A question of independence Trump's push for "gold-standard science" alarms experts who fear meddling by political appointees. **A8**

So long, 'Dave Thomas Circle' D.C. officials unveiled a new plaza in Northeast with more efficient traffic lanes to replace an intersection that had a Wendy's in the middle. **B1**

THE NATION
A Texas effort to require proof of citizenship to vote failed, but the push isn't over. **A4**
The Supreme Court left in place Maryland's ban on assault-style rifles. **A5**

THE WORLD
China and the United States are accusing each other of reneging on their tariff truce as tensions rise over rare earths exports, computer chips and student visas. **A12**

THE ECONOMY
Executive orders from President Donald Trump could mean the end of Chinese drone sales in the U.S. **A13**
Some coastal communities in the U.S. are flooding far more frequently than previously thought, researchers found. **A13**

THE REGION
A string of homicides in D.C. last month brought the city's total for the year nearly equal to the same period in 2024. **B1**
A property management firm has agreed to pay D.C. over \$1 million as part of a settlement in a lawsuit alleging a rent inflation conspiracy. **B1**

SPORTS
Cole Henry battled through the mental strain of a spate of injuries to become a Nationals reliever. **D1**

HEALTH & SCIENCE
Tech companies say their products will address problems in women's health care, but will they create others? **E1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A15
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A9

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54236

